



WORLD

GET OUT OF MY LANE!

Two-speed walking lanes are becoming increasingly common in shopping malls.

More and more shopping malls around the world are planning to introduce two-speed walking lanes for shoppers, consisting of a fast lane and a slow lane. The fast lanes are for shoppers who are in a hurry, but anyone who wants to browse slowly or use their phone as they walk has to use the slow lane.

Shopping malls in cities such as Chongqing, Antwerp, and Liverpool have already introduced this system. The idea is that faster

people will be able to overtake slower shoppers. Researchers have found that younger shoppers in particular are really frustrated by people walking slowly. Mall owners worry that this frustration might encourage people to stay away and shop online instead.

However, the plans are not without their downsides. Some people argue that officials will not be able to enforce the new rules effectively. And in Chongqing, it



has been reported that many shoppers were too busy looking at their phones to notice that they were straying into the wrong lane!

Who are the two different walking lanes for?

One is for fast walkers and one is for those who want to walk slowly.

① Where have these lanes already been introduced?

② Who are particularly frustrated by slower shoppers?

③ Why are shopping malls concerned about these frustrated shoppers?

④ What difficulty might officials face with the two-speed lanes system?

⑤ What was one of the problems with the scheme when it was introduced in Chongqing?